

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	Features of the gurdwara: the nature, history and purpose of the design of the Gurdwara as the 'Door/Gate of the Guru', including Rahit Maryada Chapters 4–6; how and why objects of devotion are used within the gurdwara: Guru Granth Sahib, takht, chanani, chaur, the langar hall, four doors, and the Nishan Sahib; divergent understandings of the importance of these features in Sikh life today.
3.2	The gurdwara: the role and importance of the gurdwara within the Sikh community including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 1391; activities that take place within the gurdwara and why; the nature and importance of visiting Sikh historical gurdwaras: the Harmandir Sahib in Amritsar (the Golden Temple); divergent understandings of the importance of making such visits, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 4.
3.3	Langar: the history of langar including Guru Granth Sahib 967; the nature and purposes of langar; the significance of langar for Sikhs today, especially as an expression of sewa.
3.4	Nam Japna – meditating on the name of God: the nature and significance of Nam Japna; diverse ways in which the Nam Japna is used in the gurdwara and in Sikh daily life, including Guru Granth Sahib 1142.
3.5*	Prayer, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 305: the nature, role and purpose of prayer in the home; the different types of prayer; when prayer might take place and why; the importance of having different prayers.
3.6	Akhand path (continuous 48-hour reading of the Guru Granth Sahib): the nature, history, role and purpose of the akhand path including reference Rahit Maryada Chapter 7; how and why Sikhs might take part in the akhand path: why the akhand path is important for the Sikh community and for individual Sikhs.
3.7	Gurpurbs and commemorations: divergent understandings of the nature, history and purpose of gurpurbs and commemorations; why they are important for Sikhs today. The origins and meaning of gurpurbs, including Guru Nanak's birthday, Vaisakhi, including reference to the account of the events found in Gurbilas Patshahi 10. Divali: the origins and meaning of commemorations, including the martyrdom of Guru Arjan and Guru Tagh Bahadur Ji.
3.8	Birth and naming rituals and ceremonies: the celebration and significance of Naam Karan and Hukamnama; the significance of Amrit Sanskar (the initiation ceremony) for Sikh families, including reference to the Rahit Maryada Chapters 11 and 13; divergent understandings of these ceremonies between khalsa and non-khalsa Sikhs; the significance of the names Singh and Kaur in the naming and Amrit ceremonies, and for Sikh identity today.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Sikh teachings about the origins and value of the universe: scientific explanations for the origins of the universe and Sikh responses to them, including the compatibility of Sikh beliefs and science; divergent Sikh responses and teachings about the value of the universe in Sikhism, including Guru Granth Sahib 1037; responses to the possible view that the universe may be used as a commodity.
4.2	Sikh teachings about the sanctity of life: Sikh teachings about why human life is holy; Sikh teachings on the sanctity of life including Guru Granth Sahib 1239; divergent understandings of the importance of sanctity of life for Sikhs today.
4.3	Sikh responses to scientific and non-religious explanations about the origins of human life including evolution and survival of the fittest with reference to interpretations of Guru Granth Sahib 19; the significance of the responses to scientific and non-religious explanations, such as evolution and survival of the fittest, for Sikhs today.
4.4	Implications of the Sikh teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of abortion: the nature of abortion; different Sikh teachings about the nature and use of abortion, including reference to Guru Granth Sahib 74 and whether life begins at conception; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them.
4.5	Sikh responses to the existence of death and the afterlife: Sikh teachings and beliefs that support the existence of a life after death; divergent Sikh responses to arguments for life after death (including remembered lives, including possible interpretations of Guru Granth Sahib 19, paranormal, logic, reward, comfort and meeting loved ones); the significance of arguments for belief in life after death for Sikhs.
4.6	Sikh responses to non-religious arguments against life after death: why Sikh reject arguments against belief in life after death (including as a source of comfort, lack of evidence, fraudulent accounts, social control), including Guru Granth Sahib 430.
4.7	Implications of the Sikh teachings about the value and sanctity of life for the issue of euthanasia: Sikh teachings about the nature and use of euthanasia, including reference to Lord Indarjit Singh's speech in the House of Lords on 12 December 2014 in the Lords' Debate on Assisted Dying; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments surrounding its use, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Sikh responses to them, including support for hospice care.
4.8	Sikh responses to issues in the natural world: Sikh responses to threats to the world, including pollution, global warming and the use of natural resources, including Guru Granth Sahib 1037; divergent Sikh responses to animal rights, including animal experimentation and the use of animals for food, and the application of ethical theories such as utilitarianism.